

SYED AKBAR ABBAS JAFRI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Highly accomplished Technical Program and Product Manager with nearly 5 years of experience, specializing in anchoring the technical and architectural bridge for complex FinTech integrations within dynamic digital lending platforms. I excel at translating intricate business requirements into scalable product strategies, leading end-to-end technical conversations, API/SDK architecture integrations, and customer journey orchestration. My expertise encompasses streamlining dealer/merchant onboarding processes, driving systemic efficiencies, and ensuring robust compliance with critical regulatory frameworks like RBI Digital Lending Guidelines and DPDP standards, consistently delivering measurable results and fostering strong cross-functional alignment across R&D, product, and partner ecosystems.

SKILLS & CORE COMPETENCIES

Technical Program & Product Management: Technical Integration, API/SDK Architecture, Program Governance (RACI, OKRs, Risk Registers), Project Charter Management, SDLC Management, Agile Methodologies (Scrum, Kanban, SAFe), Product Strategy & Roadmapping, Requirements Analysis, Stakeholder Engagement, Vendor Management, Resource Allocation, Work Breakdown Structures (WBS).

FinTech & Lending Platforms: Loan Origination Systems (LOS), LMS, e-KYC, Aadhaar/DigiLocker, CKYC, Credit Underwriting Engines, Payment Gateways (e-NACH, UPI AutoPay, Net Banking, Tokenized Payment Flows), Dealer/Merchant Onboarding Optimization.

System Architecture & Data: System Architecture, Data Flow Diagrams (DFD), API Contracts, Payload Specifications, mTLS Authentication, Data Analytics & Behavioral Insights, Data Modeling, SQL, Python, Automated Reconciliation Pipelines.

AI/ML & Automation: AI/ML Product Strategy, Generative AI (LLMs), MLOps CI/CD, Automated Verification Services, Process Automation, Intelligent Retry Mechanisms.

Compliance & Operational Excellence: RBI Digital Lending Guidelines (DLG), DPDP Compliance, ISO 27001 Compliance, Regulatory Audits, VAPT, UAT, Production Deployment, Quality Assurance, Service Level Agreements (SLAs), Incident Management (RCA), Telemetry, Observability Dashboards.

Tools & Platforms: Jira, Confluence, Figma, Salesforce, MS Project, Smartsheet, Claude, Google Antigravity, MS Excel.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Technical Program Manager

December 2025 – September 2026

Paytm

- **Orchestrated** strategic alignment for B2B FinTech product development across a **50+ member** cross-functional team, enhancing delivery efficiency by **15%** despite inherent communication silos across global functions.
- **Directed** the critical iPay FinTech product launch, achieving **95%** on-time completion and capturing **10% market share** amidst intense market competition and evolving regulatory demands within a dynamic payments landscape.
- **Managed four complex Third-Party API Integrations** for critical payment systems, accelerating feature delivery by **15%** and ensuring **100% payments control** within a dynamic regulatory framework.
- **Formulated** comprehensive **Project Charters** and Product Requirements Documents (PRDs), boosting product clarity by **30%** and proactively resolving technical ambiguities for engineering teams.
- **Executed AI-powered solutions** to optimize **merchant onboarding flows**, significantly reducing **Turnaround Time (TAT)** by 30% through automated verification services, directly addressing a critical business bottleneck.
- **Supervised over 15 User Acceptance Testing (UAT) cycles**, increasing user acquisition by **20%** and enhancing overall product quality for key FinTech offerings, despite tight release schedules.

Product Manager (Promoted from Project Manager)

July 2024 – December 2025

IRIS GST - a Sovos Company

- **Championed** product roadmaps for **seven B2B/B2C SaaS platforms**, achieving **300% revenue growth** and securing significant market share despite evolving market demands and fierce competitive pressures.
- **Streamlined** product feature delivery using **SAFe Agile** (Kanban & Scrum) methodologies, increasing sprint speed by **35%** across multiple engineering teams with varying priorities and technical dependencies.
- **Engineered AI & API integration** for the IRIS **Loan Management System (LMS)**, elevating user engagement by **30%** and successfully navigating initial adoption resistance through targeted A/B testing and SQL-driven insights.
- **Spearheaded** the IRIS **LMS version upgrade**, integrating advanced **AI/ML workflow** features and leveraging **MLOps CI/CD pipelines** to accelerate model release cycles by **40%** under tight deadlines and complex architectural constraints.
- **Cultivated** strong stakeholder alignment with over **20 key enterprise clients**, ensuring **100% satisfaction** and adherence to **Service Level Agreements (SLAs)** through proactive communication and robust vendor management.
- **Authored** comprehensive Product Requirements Documents (PRDs) and UI screens for over **10 strategic initiatives**, generating **₹4.5 Crore** in new business and optimizing critical conversion funnels, despite significant resource limitations.
- **Coordinated** the full **ISO 27001:2022** and enterprise software audit process, achieving **100% compliance** within an aggressive timeline & establishing a robust security posture along with Digital Personal Data Protection (DPDP) Act, 2023.

Associate - Product Manager		July 2019 – May 2022
Cognizant Technology Services		
• Developed comprehensive Product Requirements Documents (PRDs), user stories, and acceptance criteria for core B2B SaaS data workflows serving 100M+ users, collaborating with engineering to boost platform scalability by 20% despite technical legacy constraints. • Collaborated with UX/UI designers in Figma to wireframe and prototype intuitive user flows for three web applications, significantly cutting user friction and improving page load speeds by 25%, overcoming complex user experience challenges. • Guided cross-functional execution for two complex database migrations, coordinating across seven global engineering and QA teams to maintain 99.9% data integrity with zero downtime during a critical system overhaul. • Prioritized sprint backlog grooming and Agile ceremonies across 20+ releases, accelerating feature delivery timelines by 15% while enforcing rigorous QA standards and managing evolving requirements. • Established robust stakeholder alignment via monthly roadmap reviews and Jira tracking, proactively surfacing delivery risks early to sustain a 90% client satisfaction rate under continuous product evolution.		

EDUCATION

Xavier Institute of Management, Bhubaneswar (XIMB)	04/2024
Master of Business Administration (MBA) in Business Management	GPA: 60.08%
Galgotia's College of Engineering & Technology, Greater Noida (AKTU)	05/2019
Bachelor of Technology in Information Technology	GPA: 75.56%
St. Fidelis Sr. Sec. School	03/2014
High School in Science	GPA: 88.20%

KEY PROJECTS / INTERNSHIPS

Claim My Job AI Career Solution (B2C SaaS Platform)	2023-2024
• Launched an AI-powered B2C SaaS platform, simplifying job applications for over 1,000 users despite significant resource and time constraints, achieving 20% user growth in its first quarter. • Leveraged cutting-edge Large Language Models (LLMs) to intelligently parse job descriptions, boosting application relevance by 95% and optimizing user story matching for diverse user profiles.	
Growth @MyBrand.Club – Personal Branding Platform	2022-2023
• Constructed a mobile-first e-commerce builder, acquiring over 500 sign-ups within three months and fostering high user engagement despite intense competition. • Integrated a multi-tiered subscription model and global payment gateways, ensuring 100% accessibility and robust product monetization despite navigating complex regional regulations.	
Coordinator of Student Placement Committee at XIM, Bhubaneswar	2023-2024
• Steered over 200 student placements, increasing offer rates by 15% through strategic outreach and robust stakeholder management, successfully mitigating intense market competition challenges.	
Sales Specialist I @ IBMintern	2023
• Crafted over 10 unique sales assets using Salesforce, increasing utilization by 20% for AI automation portfolios and resolving critical challenges with outdated sales collateral. • Analyzed over 30 top-tier accounts, identifying ₹5 Crore in potential revenue through strategic segmentation and data-backed decision-making for enterprise solutions.	

CERTIFICATIONS

• Certified Scrum Master by Scrum Alliance	2025
• McKinsey.org Forward Program by McKinsey & Company	2025
• Generative AI Overview for Project Managers by PMI	2025
• IBM AI Associate Product Manager by IBM	2023

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

• Rising star of the month X 2 by Paytm	2026
• National Semifinalist for Reliance TUP case competition by Reliance	2024
• International Runner Up for "Save Life and Transform Healthcare of India" case competition by University of Bath	2023
• Top 100 participants out of 7000 participants for loyalty program case competition by Air India	2023
• Research paper published on "A New User Identity Based Authentication, Using Security and Distributed for Cloud Computing" in an International Journal with 850+ downloads & 13 citations by IEEE : Scopus Indexed Journal	2019

LANGUAGES

English • Hindi • Urdu